

How much AI is too much environment wise?

Posted by u/MonadoboyAJ • 0 points • 6 comments

Hey, so I use AI alot for things like initial ideas, specific questions similar to this one, as an info store and for proofreading. Two other big ones are cooking and teaching me about my job where I'm new and have been manager-less for 3 months!

Now, I am of course conscious about it reducing my comprehensive skills, so I ask it to teach me where possible. Though I admit sometimes I'm not taking in that information fully.

With all this already on my mind already, learning about the chat GPT energy usage became a concern for me. At one point I was using it less as a result, and that's great. Then I fell into using it again. Recently I was reminded of this. I'd like to not just have these passing thoughts but ask actual people. Recently I've been using Reddit to do just that, get people's opinions when I want to ask someone but need a specialist. In this case I don't know where I'd ask. I also do not want to ask AI about AI usage. It won't even proof read this.

Following that preamble, I'd like to know: How do I know if I'm using AI too much, taking both the environment and my natural human skills into consideration?

Comments

u/archpaw • 1 points • 2025-07-27 23:16 UTC

[Here's something that goes into it in depth.](<https://andymasley.substack.com/p/a-cheat-sheet-for-conversations-about>)

> By being vegan, I have as much climate impact as not prompting ChatGPT 400,000 times each year (the water impact is even bigger). I don't think I'm going to come close to prompting ChatGPT 400,000 times in my life, so each year I effectively stop more than a person's entire lifetime of ChatGPT searches with a single lifestyle change. If I choose not to take a flight to Europe, I save 3,500,000 ChatGPT searches. this is like stopping more than 7 people from searching ChatGPT for their entire lives. Preventing ChatGPT searches is a hopelessly useless lever for the climate movement to try to pull. We have so many tools at our disposal to make the climate better. Why make everyone feel guilt over something that won't have any impact?

u/generic_redditor_71 • 3 points • 2025-07-27 22:20 UTC

AI consumes similar amounts of energy and water as other internet services. If you're not tying yourself in knots over the environmental impact of you watching 20 seconds of a youtube video, you don't need

to worry about AI either.

u/Nice_Original3004 • -1 points • 2025-07-27 22:18 UTC

The whole carbon footprint thing is propaganda from fossil fuel corporations. The environment going to crap is THEIR fault and only THEY can cause genuinely significant improvements.

u/Glass_Confusion448 • 1 points • 2025-07-27 22:17 UTC

Have you calculated how much energy and water your AI use costs?

Once you calculate that, you can compare it to the energy and water available and your other uses of energy and water to see if you are consuming more than you pay for and more than can be supported.

u/Partnumber • 1 points • 2025-07-27 22:13 UTC

Only you can decide where your personal boundaries are in regards to product consumption of any kind, including ai.

AI can be a useful tool, but it has its cost like anything else. Energy usage, carbon emissions, what are consumption, and fostering an environment of over Reliance are some of those costs.

You have to weigh that against your personal convenience and conscience, and decide how much is too much

u/MonadoboyAJ • 1 points • 2025-07-27 22:19 UTC

Thank you for your response. Yes I agree with you. I suppose I should probably do some more research into it so I can make that decision. Is it too cheeky to ask another question underneath my main one. Just if anyone knows a good starting place to learn.